

Ransomware Ordeals: From Start to Finish

The journey of a typical ransomware attack.

Presenter

Calum Baird

Date

10/09/2025



Agenda

- Introduce the speaker
- Explain ransomware
- Ransomware groups
- Notable ransomware incidents
- Ransom extortion methods
- Typical timeline of a ransomware incident
- Ransomware negotiations
- Aspects to consider

Who am I?

- Joined the Police Service of Scotland in 2014
 - Left Computer Science studies
 - Began studying Computing & IT at The Open University
- Moved to Digital Forensics Unit in 2020
 - Operation NOCAP / PARROR
- Moved to Cybercrime Investigations Unit in 2022
 - Specialist cybercrime investigations
 - Working with international partners
- Moved to Systal Technology Solutions in 2023



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What is Ransomware?

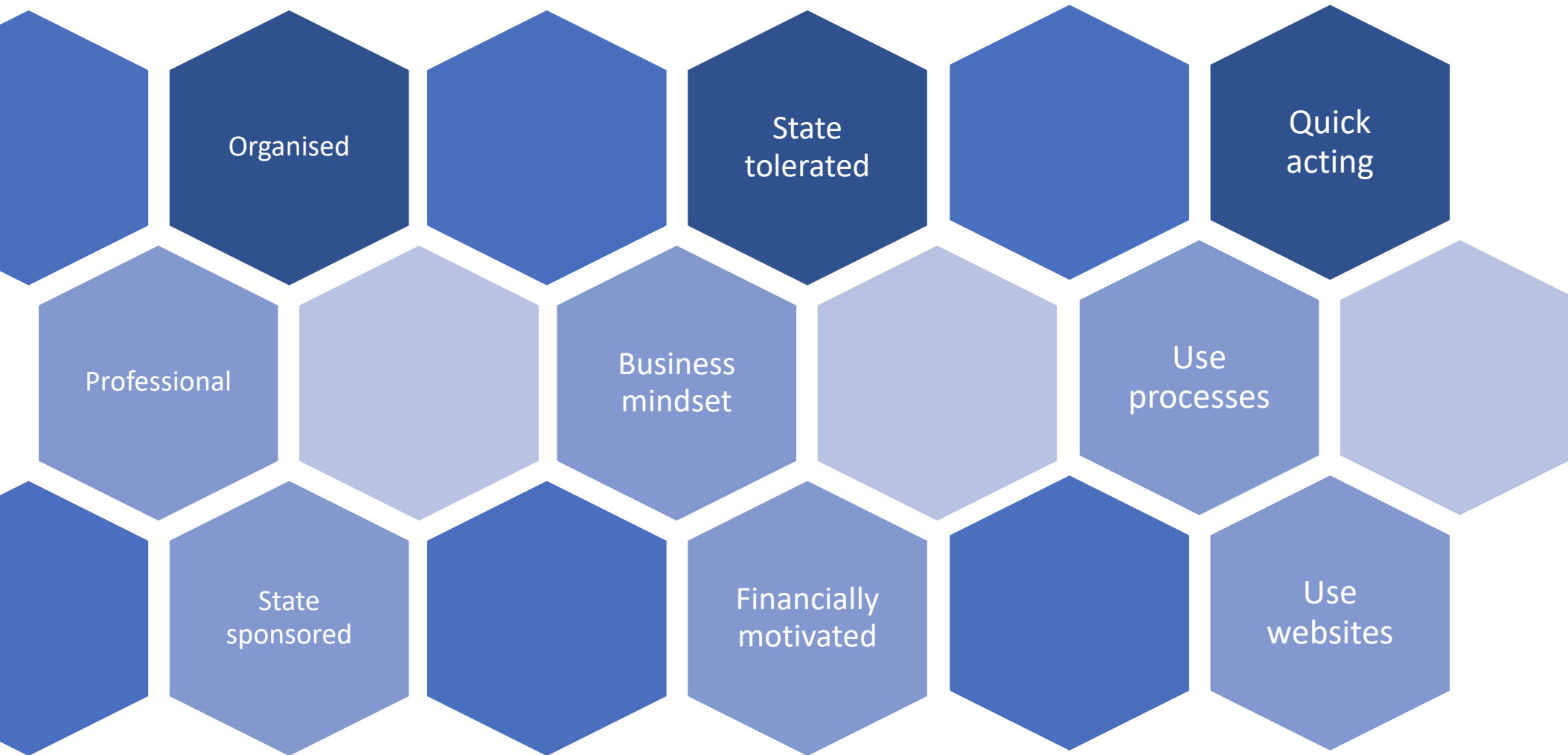
Malware deployed by threat actors which typically

prevents access to systems and/or data and

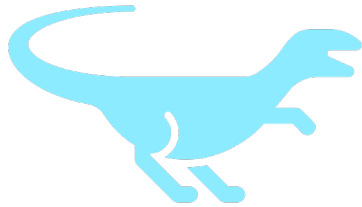
threatens to continue this malicious action, or undertake additional malicious actions,

unless a ransom payment is made.

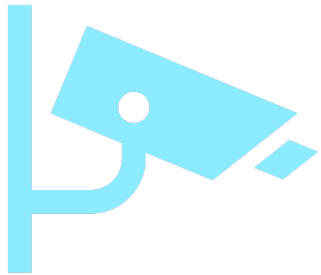
Ransomware Threat Actor Groups



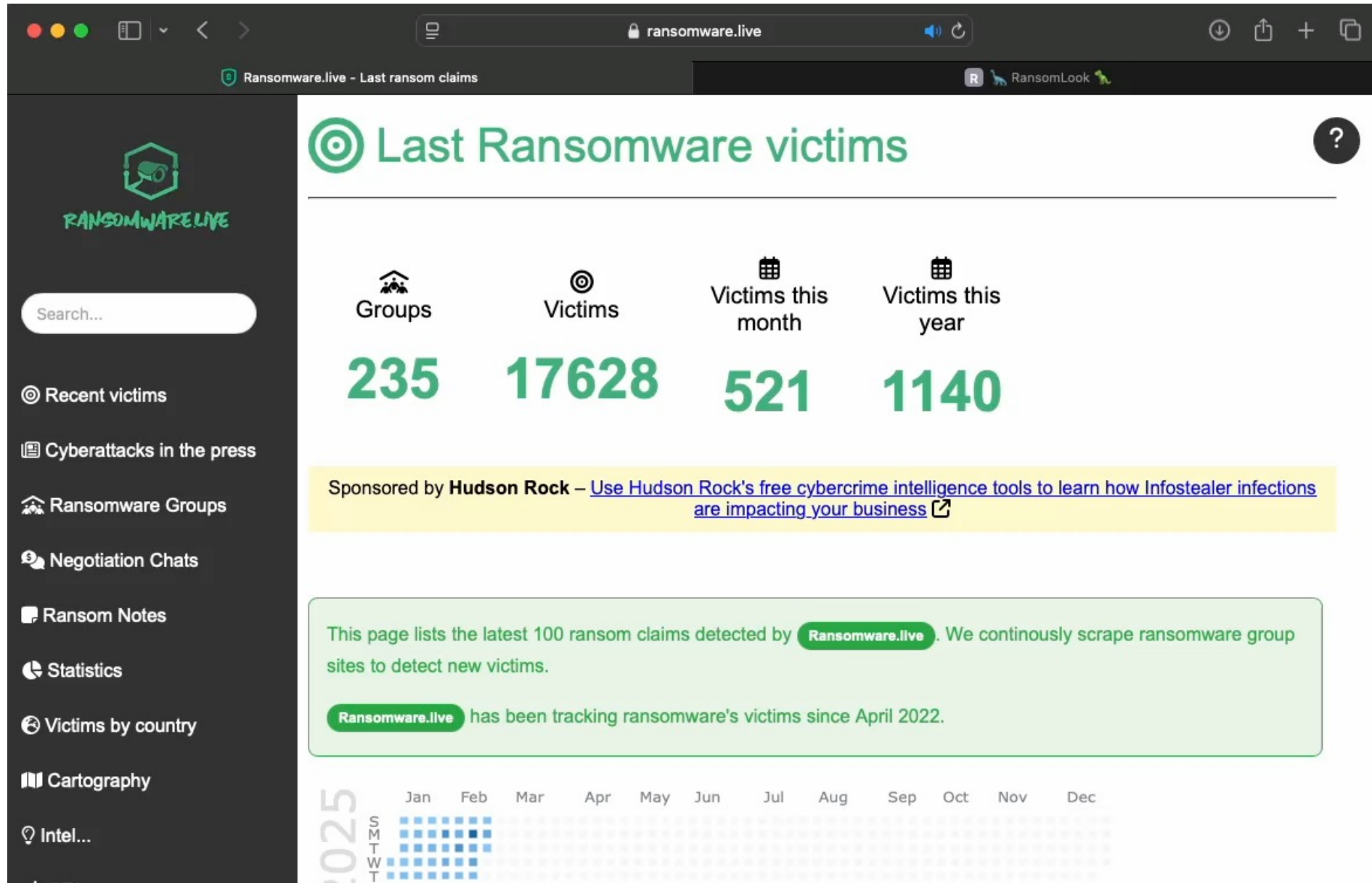
Tracking Ransomware Threat Actor Groups



<https://www.ransomware.live/>



<https://www.ransomlook.io>



Scottish Ransomware Incidents

NAO

National Audit Office

Report – Value for Money

Investigation

Date: 27 Oct 2019

Topics: Digital security

Departments: Digital Security

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Full cost of 2020 cyberattacks on Scotland's water supply still not known

© 1 February 2022

By Russell Blackstock

Thousand of people in Scotland have been affected by a cyberattack on the water supply.



By Andrew Picken

Scullion LAW becomes victim of cyberattack

26 MAR 2024 | Reading time: 2 minutes

Scullion Law has become the victim of a cyberattack.

The firm has been targeted by Russian ransomware operator Black Basta.

The firm, which has offices in Hamilton, Edinburgh – and Madrid – has had 155 gigabytes of data stolen.

A spokesperson for the firm said: “We can confirm that we were recently the victim of a cyberattack. We promptly notified the ICO and the Law Society of Scotland, and have been working with the police, external IT and legal experts.

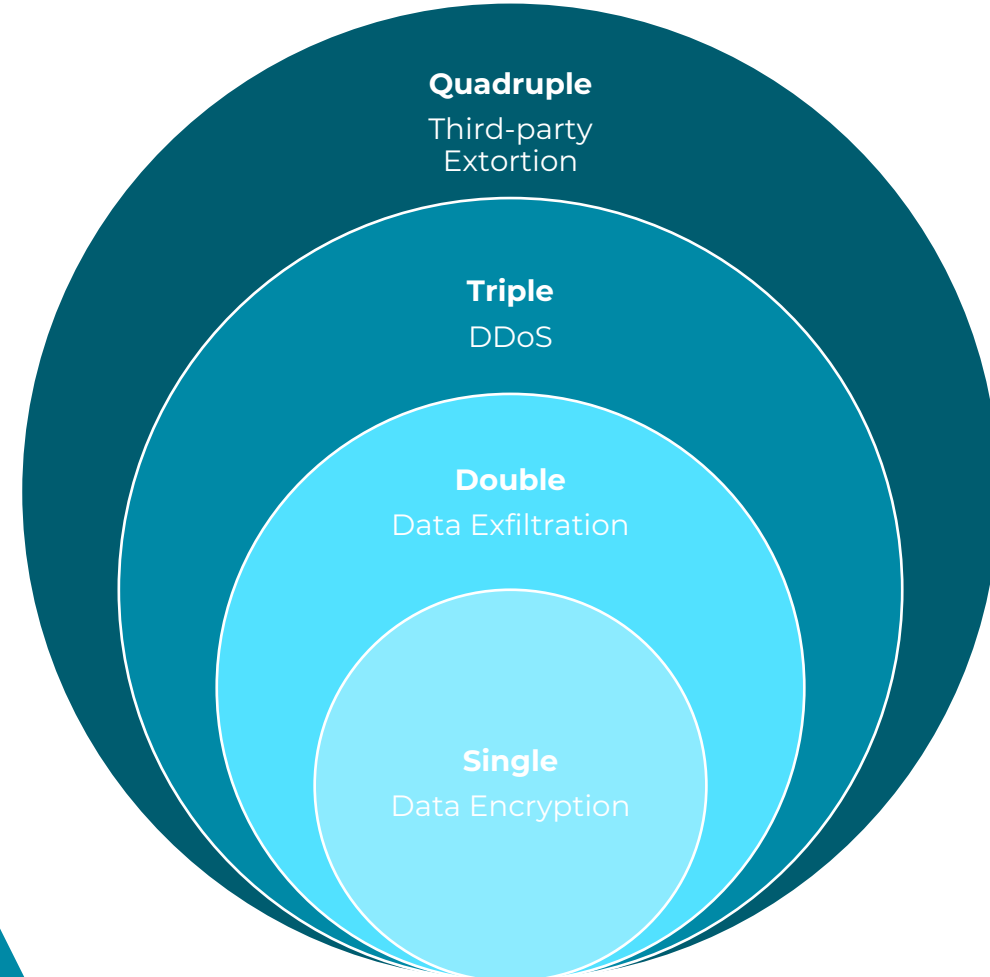
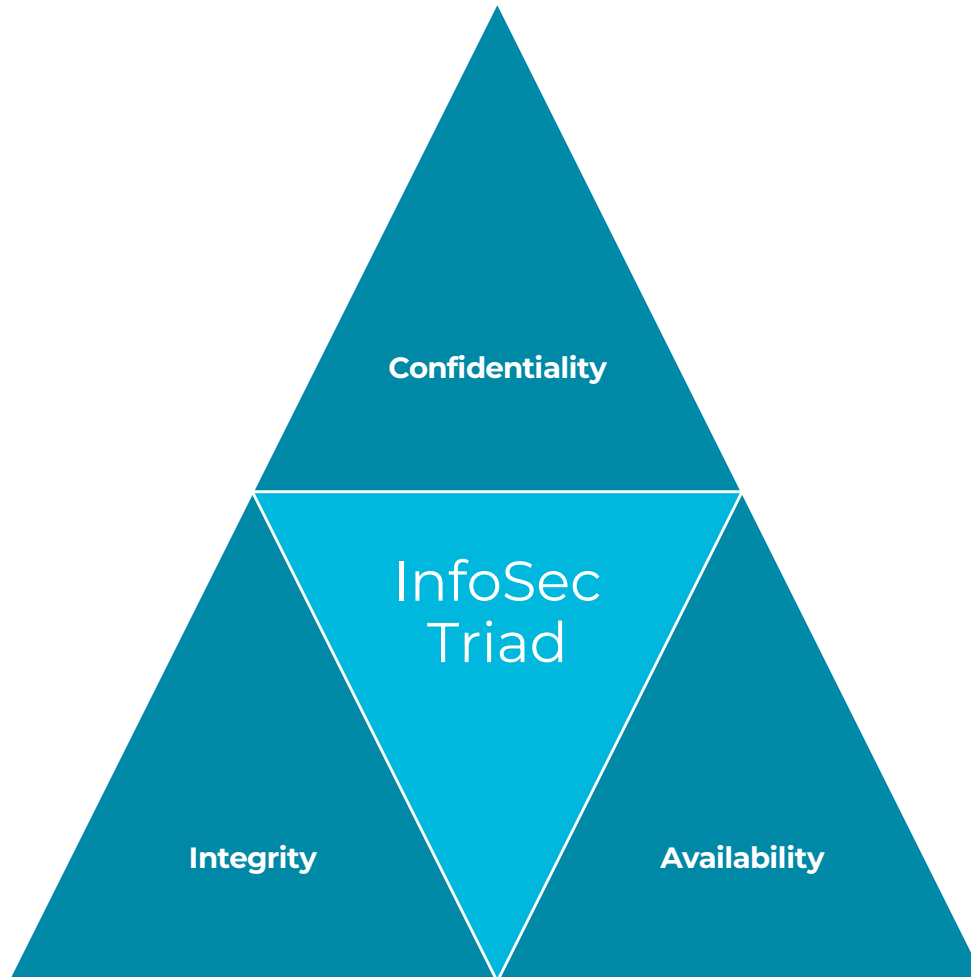


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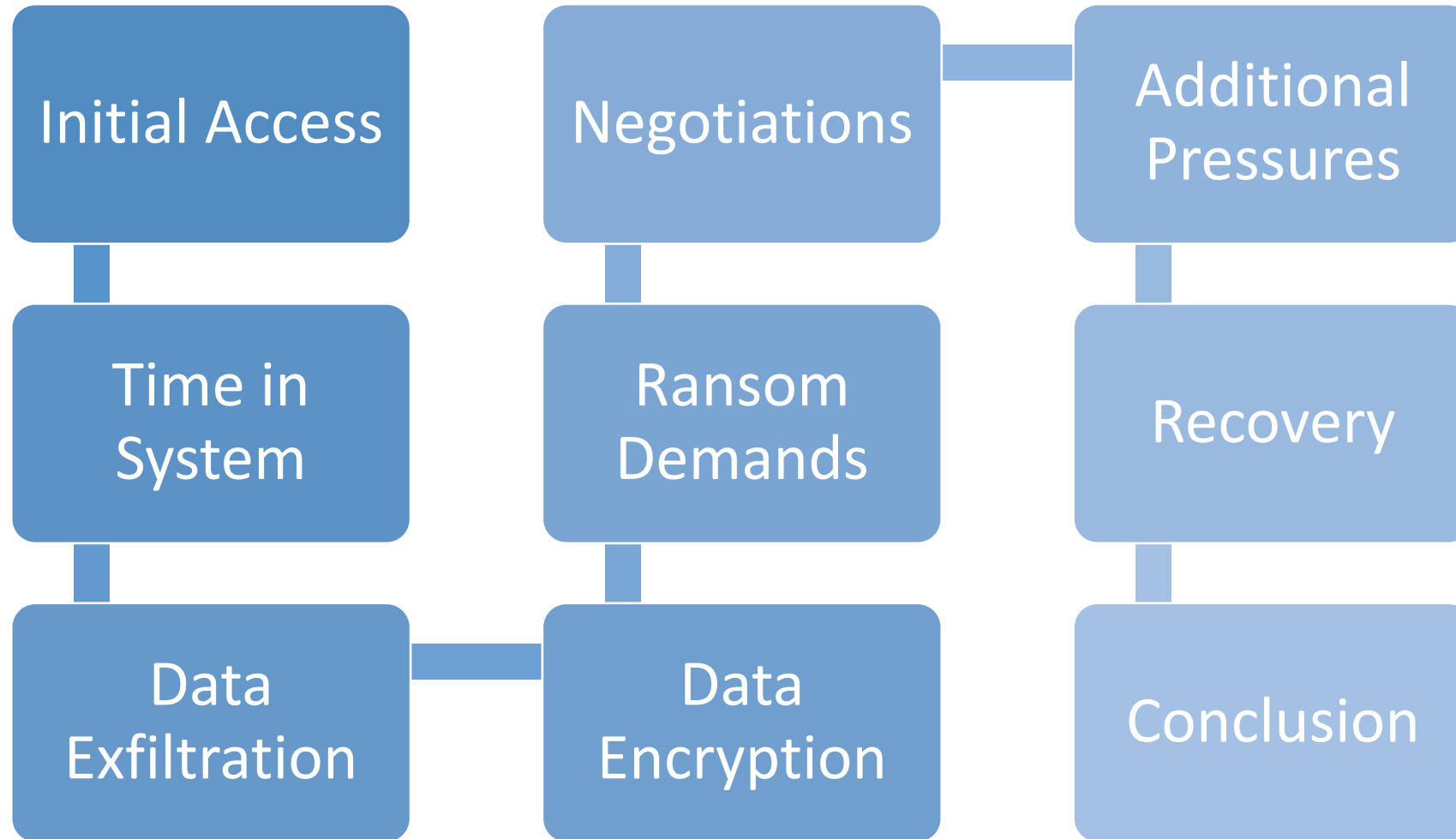
8

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Ransomware Multi-Extortion Methods



Ransomware



Ransomware Negotiations

Ransomware threat actors are professionals

As with any negotiations, they can turn sour

Can be useful to buy time and gather information

Proof of compromise

Threat actor reputation

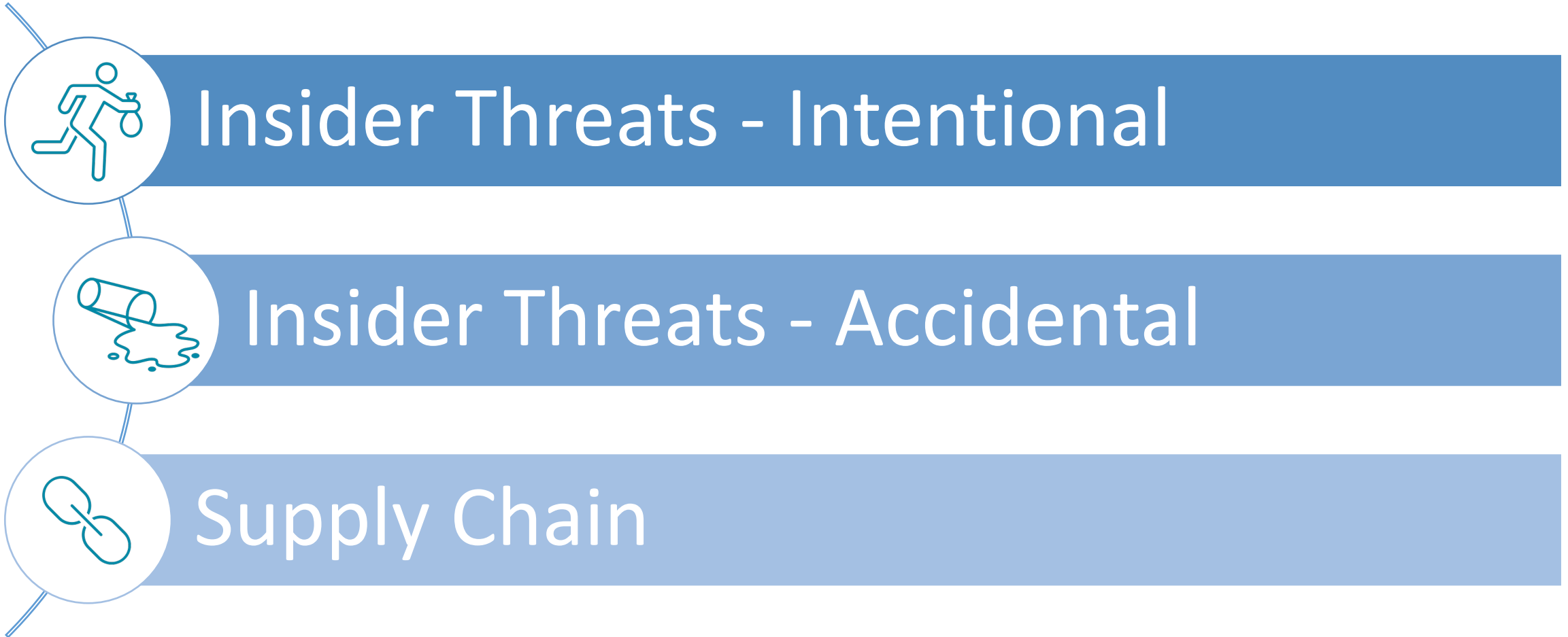
Can you pay?

Should you pay?



<https://tinyurl.com/ransomsim>

Ransomware – Aspects to Consider



Questions?